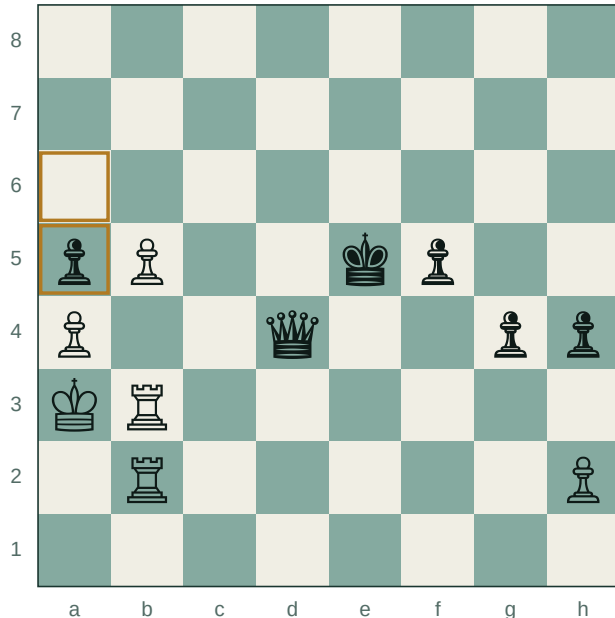


# Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 67

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 66...a5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**67. b6 Qd6+ 68. Ka2**

**67.b6** The pawn moves from b5 to b6. Recorded reply: **67...Qd6+**.

**68.Ka2** The king moves from a3 to a2.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

## HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on e5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.